

UNESCO Square for Tolerance and Peace (Hebrew: מִּסְלָס תּוֹנְלָבוּס לְוִ'קְסָנוּא רִכִּיכ, romanized: Kikar UNESCO LeSovlanut UleShalom; commonly referred to as UNESCO Square) is a roundabout located in the German Colony in Haifa, Israel. The square is situated at the base of the garden terraces around the Shrine of the Báb on Mount Carmel, at the intersection of Ben-Gurion Boulevard and HaGeffen Street, which leads to the Arab neighborhoods in Haifa's downtown. On its southern side lies the main entrance plaza to the Bahá'í Gardens, and on its northern side begins the German Colony promenade.

The square is named after UNESCO, the United Nations' educational, scientific and cultural organization. It was inaugurated on 9 December 2012, in honor of UNESCO's declaration of the Bahá'í Gardens in Haifa as a World Heritage Site on 8 July 2008, and in celebration of the local Holiday of Holidays festival held on the same date. The inauguration ceremony was attended by Haifa's mayor, Yona Yahav, and the Secretary-General of the worldwide Bahá'í community, Albert Lincoln. During the opening ceremony, dozens of white doves were released throughout the area. On 30 May 2011, a year and a half before the inauguration, a naming ceremony for the square took place, attended by UNESCO's Director-General, Irina Bokova.

Gallery

Notes

== References ==